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10.7.1 Causes for Rural Unemployment

Causes for rural unemployment in India are discussed below:

1. **Absence of skill development and employment generation:** Lack of Government initiatives to give required training and then to generate employment opportunities.
2. **Seasonal Nature of Agriculture**: Agricultural operations are seasonal in nature and depend much on nature and rainfall. Therefore, the demand for labour becomes negligible during off-season. So, non-farm employment opportunities must be created.
3. **Lack of Subsidiary Occupation**: Rural people are not able to start subsidiary occupations such as poultry, rope making, piggery etc. due to shortages of funds for investment and lack of proper marketing arrangements. This restricts the employment opportunity and rural family incomes. Government must arrange funds for these people. However, as now they pay huge interest to the local money lenders, for they are unable to get loans from formal sources.
4. **Mechanization of Agriculture**: The landlords are the principal source of employment to the farm labour. Mechanization of agricultural operations like ploughing, irrigation, harvesting, threshing etc. reduces employment opportunities for the farm labour.
5. **Capital-Intensive Technology**: The expanding private industrial sector is largely found in urban areas and not creating additional employment opportunities due to the application of capital intensive technologies. Government must establish firms to absorb surplus labour power.
6. **Defective System of Education**: The present system of education has also aggravated the rural unemployment problem.Large number of degree-producing institutions has come in the recent years. Students also want to get degrees only, not any skill. Degrees should be awarded only on the basis of skills acquired. The unemployed youth should get sufficient facilities to update their skills.

10.7.2 Remedies for Rural Unemployment

In order to reduce rural unemployment in the country there is a need to take integrated and coordinated efforts from various levels. A few remedial measures are listed below:

1. **Subsidiary Occupation**: To reduce the seasonal unemployment rural people should be encouraged to adopt subsidiary occupations. Loans should be granted and proper arrangements should be made for marketing their products.
2. **Rural Works Programme**: Rural Works Programme such as construction and maintenance of roads, digging of drains, canals, etc should be planned during off-season